

2022

北京卷 阅读 D

量子计算热潮中的炒作与信任

议论文 · 科技与社会 · 全文 387 词 · 逐句精读

¹ Quantum (量子) computers have been on my mind a lot lately.

最近我常常想到量子计算机。

quantum adj. 量子的

on one's mind 挂在心上；惦记着

lately adv. 最近

² A friend has been sending me articles on how quantum computers might help solve some of the biggest challenges we face as humans.

一位朋友一直给我发文章，讲量子计算机可能如何帮助我们人类面临的一些最大挑战。

article n. 文章

solve v. 解决

challenge n. 挑战

face v. 面对；面临

human n. 人类

³ I've also had exchanges with two quantum-computing experts.

我还和两位量子计算专家交流过。

exchange n. 交流；交谈

expert n. 专家

⁴ One is computer **scientist** Chris Johnson, who I **see as** someone who helps keep the **field honest**.

一位是计算机科学家克里斯·约翰逊，在我看来，他是帮助这个领域保持实事求是的人。

scientist n. 科学家

see...as 把……看作

field n. 领域

honest adj. 诚实的

⁵ The other is physicist Philip Taylor.

另一位是物理学家菲利普·泰勒。

physicist n. 物理学家

⁶ For **decades**, quantum computing has been **little more than** a **laboratory curiosity**.

几十年来，量子计算不过是实验室里的新奇玩意儿。

decade n. 十年

little more than 不过是；仅仅是

laboratory n. 实验室

curiosity n. 新奇的事物；稀罕物

⁷ Now, big **tech** companies have **invested in** quantum computing, **as have** many smaller ones.

如今，大型科技公司已经投资量子计算，许多规模较小的公司也是如此。

tech n. 科技；技术

invest in 投资于

as have也是如此（倒装）

8 According to Business Weekly, quantum machines could help us “cure cancer, and even take steps to turn climate change in the opposite direction.”

据《商业周刊》报道，量子机器可能帮助我们“治愈癌症，甚至采取措施扭转气候变化的方向”。

according to 根据；据……报道

cure v. 治愈

cancer n. 癌症

take steps 采取措施

climate change 气候变化

opposite adj. 相反的

direction n. 方向

⁹ This is the sort of hype (炒作) that annoys Johnson.

这正是让约翰逊恼火的那种炒作。

the sort of 这种；那类

hype n. 炒作；大肆宣传

annoy v. 使恼怒

¹⁰ He worries that **researchers** are **making promises** they can't **keep**.

他担心研究人员正在作出无法兑现的承诺。

researcher n. 研究人员

make promises 作出承诺

keep v. 信守；履行（诺言）

11 “What’s new,” Johnson wrote, “is that **millions of** dollars are now **potentially available** to quantum computing researchers.”

“新情况在于，”约翰逊写道，“量子计算研究人员现在有可能获得数百万美元的资金。”

millions of 数百万的

potentially adv. 可能地；潜在地

available adj. 可获得的

¹² As quantum computing **attracts** more **attention** and **funding**, researchers may **mislead** **investors**, **journalists**, **the public** and, **worst of all**, themselves about their work's **potential**.

随着量子计算吸引越来越多的关注和资金，研究人员可能会就自身工作的潜力误导投资者、记者和公众，最糟糕的是，还会误导自己。

attract v. 吸引

attention n. 关注；注意

funding n. 资金；拨款

mislead v. 误导

investor n. 投资者

journalist n. 记者

the public 公众

worst of all 最糟糕的是

potential n. 潜力

13 If researchers can't keep their **promises**, **excitement** might **give way to** **doubt**, **disappointment** and anger, Johnson **warns**.

约翰逊警告说，如果研究人员不能兑现承诺，兴奋可能会被怀疑、失望和愤怒所取代。

promise n. 承诺

excitement n. 兴奋；激动

give way to 被……取代；让位于

doubt n. 怀疑

disappointment n. 失望

warn v. 警告

¹⁴ Lots of other **technologies** have **gone through** **stages** of excitement.

许多其他技术也都经历过备受热捧的阶段。

technology n. 技术

go through 经历

stage n. 阶段

15 But something about quantum computing makes it **especially** **prone** to hype, Johnson **suggests**, perhaps because “quantum’ **stands for** something **cool** you shouldn’t be able to understand.”

但约翰逊表示，量子计算有某种特质，使它特别容易被炒作，这或许是因为“‘量子’代表着某种很酷、你本就理解不了的东西”。

especially adv. 尤其；特别

prone adj. 易于……的；容易受……影响的

suggest v. （委婉地）提出（看法）；认为

stand for 代表；意味着

cool adj. 很酷的；绝妙的

¹⁶ And that brings me back to Taylor, who suggested that I read his book Q for Quantum.

这又把话题带回到泰勒身上，是他建议我读读他的书《Q代表量子》。

bring...back to 使回到（话题、人物）

suggest v. 建议

¹⁷ After I read the book, Taylor patiently answered my questions about it.

我读完这本书后，泰勒耐心地回答了我关于这本书的问题。

patiently adv. 耐心地

answer v. 回答

¹⁸ He also answered my questions about PyQuantum, the **firm** he **co-founded** in 2016.

他还回答了我关于PyQuantum的问题，这家公司是他2016年与人共同创办的。

firm n. 公司

co-found v. 共同创办

¹⁹ Taylor **shares** Johnson's **concerns** about hype, but he says those concerns do not **apply to** PyQuantum.

泰勒和约翰逊一样担心炒作问题，但他说这些担忧并不适用于 PyQuantum。

share v. 有同样的（看法、感受）

concern n. 担忧；关切

apply to 适用于

²⁰ The company, he says, is **closer** than any other firm “by a very large **margin** (幅度)” **to** building a “**useful**” quantum computer, one that “solves an **impactful** problem that we would not have been able to solve **otherwise**.”

他说，该公司比其他任何公司都更接近于造出一台“有用的”量子计算机，而且领先的“幅度非常大”；这种计算机能“解决一个影响重大、否则我们无法解决的问题”。

close to 接近于（本句比较级 closer ... to：更接近于）

margin n. 幅度；差额

useful adj. 有用的

impactful adj. 影响重大的

otherwise adv. 否则；不然

²¹ He **adds**, “People will **naturally** **discount** my **opinions**, but I have spent a lot of time **quantitatively** **comparing** what we are doing **with** what others are doing.”

他还说：“人们自然会对我的观点打折扣，但我花了很多时间，把我们正在做的事和别人正在做的事作了定量比较。”

add v. 补充说；又说

naturally adv. 自然地；理所当然地

discount v. 对……打折扣看待；不全信

opinion n. 观点；看法

quantitatively adv. 定量地

compare...with 把……与……比较

²² Could PyQuantum really be leading all the competition “by a very large margin”, as Taylor claims?

PyQuantum真的有可能像泰勒声称的那样，正“以非常大的幅度”领先所有竞争对手吗？

lead v. 领先于

competition n. 竞争对手

claim v. 声称

²³ I don't **know**.

我不知道。

know v. 知道

²⁴ I'm certainly not going to advise my friend or anyone else to invest in quantum computers.

我当然不会建议我的朋友或其他任何人投资量子计算机。

certainly adv. 当然；肯定

advise v. 建议；劝告

invest v. 投资

25 But I **trust** Taylor, **just as** I trust Johnson.

但我信任泰勒，正如我信任约翰逊一样。

trust v. 信任

just as 正如